
BINANCE

BINANCE SETTLES

090 / 21 NOV 2023 / CHANGPENG ZHAO / UNCOMMON

THE DOOR CLOSES.

On 21 November 2023, Binance pleaded guilty in the United States to federal charges involving anti-money-laundering requirements, unlicensed money transmission and sanctions violations. The company agreed to a Justice Department resolution totaling $4,316,126,163: $2,510,650,588 in forfeiture and a $1,805,475,575 criminal fine. The total belonged to Binance, rather than its founder personally, and combined different forms of financial penalty.

The resolution formed part of coordinated action involving the Justice Department, FinCEN, OFAC and the CFTC. Their responsibilities covered financial-crime controls, sanctions and derivatives-market rules. Credits and offsets connected the settlements, so the agencies' headline amounts cannot simply be added together. The CFTC agreement announced that day still required court approval. Treasury also required extensive compliance changes and a five-year monitorship.

Changpeng Zhao, known as CZ, faced a separate case. He pleaded guilty to failing to maintain an effective anti-money-laundering program under the Bank Secrecy Act and resigned as CEO. A symbolic dog-like figure walks away with paperwork while staff remain at work behind glass. The scene represents leadership change, not imprisonment, bankruptcy or the exchange's closure.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 THE DEPARTING FIGURE

The same symbolic host from card 040 now walks towards the viewer. His departure stands for Zhao leaving the CEO role; it does not portray a real journey or an arrest.

02 THE CLOSED GLASS DOORS

The entrance behind him is shut, but the office remains occupied. THE DOOR CLOSES. refers to a leadership chapter ending, not Binance shutting down.

03 THE WORK CONTINUES

Colleagues are still at their screens beyond the glass. Their presence distinguishes the company's continuing operations from its founder's resignation.

04 THE PAPERWORK

The plain folder and loose papers suggest a formal departure. They bear no agency or BNB labels and are not authenticated settlement documents or a record of a particular charge.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Sources: DOJ resolution, 21 Nov 2023; Treasury enforcement, 21 Nov 2023; CFTC agreement, 21 Nov 2023; CZ's Broccoli post, reported by The Block. The departure scene is fictional. The avatar is inspired by CZ's Belgian Malinois Broccoli, publicly introduced in February 2025, not a depiction of the real pet at the 2023 event or an endorsement of a token. THE DOOR CLOSES. is editorial, not a quotation. Artwork approval does not establish commercial rights clearance.